

# A HEALTHY GARDEN

The varieties of fruits and vegetables in this book have been chosen for taste and reliability but also in many cases for their resistance to pests and diseases. However, no plant can be completely resistant and all will benefit from good growing conditions, vigilance, and fast action at the first sign of damage.

## PESTS

The pests in your garden range from slugs or snails that love to feed on young seedlings to aphids that secrete honeydew on plants on which gray mold can develop. Methods of control can be biological, organic, or chemical.



**Slugs target vulnerable new plants.**

## PREVENTION

Try to pest-proof your plot with a few of these methods:

- Cover seeds or young plants with a protective enclosure, such as a cloche or polytunnel, to prevent attack from insects, birds, and small mammals.
- Interplant your crops with companion plants, such as marigolds, to divert insect pests.
- Encourage insect predators such as ladybugs by providing them with a wildlife habitat.
- Set up traps or other deterrents to thwart slugs and snails.
- Hang old CDs, or place upturned plastic bottles on sticks—as the wind catches them, the noise and movement will help to discourage unwanted visitors.
- Use netting to deter birds.
- Place grease bands around the trunks of susceptible fruit trees.

## TREATMENT

- Use a chemical pesticide. Be aware though that these often kill more than just your pests, and might cause a knock-on effect in your garden's food chain.
- Use parasitic nematodes, which enter the bodies of slugs and snails and trigger a fatal infection.